

we'll reveal how to access location-based services and implement geo-tags in your application.

Some applications run as services in the background without a user interface. You'll learn to create and control such services, and also set up their self-termination. You'll then be able to bind activities to services and set requisite priorities for these services. Threading these background services will follow. We'll also introduce you to the Toast view in Android, which is like a status update of a service on the user interface, and takes up minimal screen estate.

You'll see how easy it is to implement user notifications for hardware and software, which are similar to notifications of new text messages through flashing LEDs. We'll teach you to implement icons with notification so that it's an activity-specific indicator. Bluetooth services handling will also be covered.

Having understood the 'smart' of your smartphone, the next logical step would be telephony and SMS handling. In this section, you'll be familiarised with implementing 'phone' related activities and handling them. Since a user will connect to the internet using Wi-Fi at several instances, you'll learn to monitor, scan and create Wi-Fi networks and network configurations. 